

Report Kickoff Memo Description

Due: Printed for submission in class

Overview

Your group is set to formalize the topic, or issue, that you will discuss in your report. Now, brainstorm about a topic, complete a worksheet (see reverse), and write a brief memo to our class that captures important early decisions you have made about framing the issue and how you will organize the document.

Task

Come to an agreement about a topic, then complete the Kickoff Memo Worksheet on the reverse side of this sheet. Finally, transfer your ideas to a brief, four-part memo that mirrors the Worksheet and includes the following information described below. Make sure you **review the template** provided on our Blackboard site.

Structure of the Memo

Use the Report Kickoff Memo Template in the module on Canvas, and keep the memo to one page. The Kickoff Memo Template divides the memo into these four parts:

Purpose

This paragraph briefly explains the memo's purpose, tells the reader what the memo will do etc. This section **must** state the issue or topic as you know it today.

— *Suggested paragraph length: 1-2 sentences*

Background Information

Here, you provide general background information about the issue. After they read this paragraph, your audience should understand the topic at a fundamental level. You may, for example,

- give the history of the issue
- describe who it affects, when it began, how it appeared, etc.
- introduce early evidence about why the topic is relevant

In other words, this paragraph allows the reader to understand the issue's basic facts. Cite sources of all information beyond a general level.

— *Suggested paragraph length: one short paragraph of 5 sentences; if you need over 5 sentences, split the paragraphs.*

Problem and Purpose Statements

Provide the problem and purpose statements that will frame your report. Refer to the discussion in Rentz (201-202) and our class discussion for more information about these two statements.

— *Suggested paragraph length: a two-bullet list per the template format*

Factors to Investigate

Report topics, subtopics or "Factors" can be loosely described as those important ideas you will investigate in the report. Think of them as subheadings in the report itself. Provide a list of them here; for help, see the discussion in Rentz (202-204) and refer to our class discussion.

— *Suggested paragraph length: an appropriate number of bullets per the topic and type of report*

Do not alter the memo format: keep all text in Arial 10, black, and maintain the line spacing on the template. Memos deviating from this format will be returned. You do not need to submit the worksheet.